



TIPS & TRICKS



How to find the serial number of the hard disk from the command line

To find the serial number of the hard disk from the command line, execute the following command:

```
#hdparm -I /dev/sda | grep Serial
```

The output of the above command is the serial number of the `/dev/sda` hard disk.

Here's another tip to get an ASCII man page file, without the annoying backspace/underscore attempts at underlining, and the weird sequences. For example, to get the `rsync` manual page in a plain text file, execute the following command:

```
#man rsync | col -b >/root/rsync
```

—Suresh Jagtap,

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Google through the terminal

You can now Google through your terminal, i.e., by using `Googler`. Here is the process of using it on Ubuntu.

To install it in Ubuntu, first make sure you have Python version 3.3 or later, by using the following command:

```
#python3 -version
```

If the version of Python is not correct, upgrade it. `Googler` requires Python 3.3+ to run.

Though `Googler` is not available through the package repository on Ubuntu, we can easily install it from the GitHub repository. All we have to do is run the following set of commands:

```
#cd /tmp
#git clone https://github.com/jarun/googler.git
#cd googler
#sudo make install
#cd auto-completion/bash/
```

```
#sudo cp googler-completion.bash /etc/bash_completion.d/
```

And that's it. `Googler` is installed along with the command auto-completion feature.

After installing it, just run the command '`Googler`' and start searching on Google.

—Mounica Revuru,

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Nuke a whole directory recursively in Posix-type systems

The `shred` command, which is used to irrecoverably wipe out individual files or drives, can be creatively combined with `find` and `xargs` to destroy a directory's files only (say, `/home/moi/.ssh`), as follows:

```
date;find /home/moi/.ssh/ -type f -print0 | xargs -0 shred
-zfun5;date
```

The two date sub-commands, at the start and at the end, will give you the start and end times for the operation, should you wish to calculate the time it takes. The `n5` overwrites each file five times with random data, so you can adjust this by simply varying the number five. The `z` flag finally fills file contents with 0s, `u` removes the files while `f` tries to force shredding by altering permission. Empty directories remain. **Note:** Do not shred the wrong location in a hurry.

—A. Data, webmaster@aucklandwhich.org



Creating a new user on Linux

You are working on a project and you want to keep it systematically arranged on your system, but looking at your desktop makes you wonder how to first arrange it all. Don't worry, you can create a new user, which will give you an interface similar to a new PC with everything that you have on your existing user already installed.

Open the terminal and enter the following command